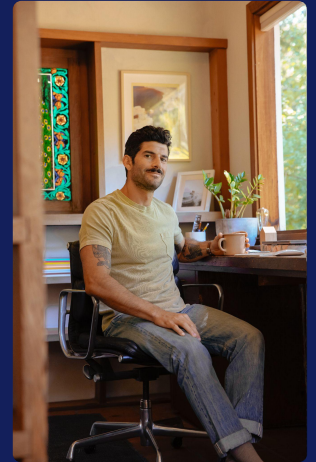




Maximizing Medicare Sales Year Round with SEP's



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Agenda

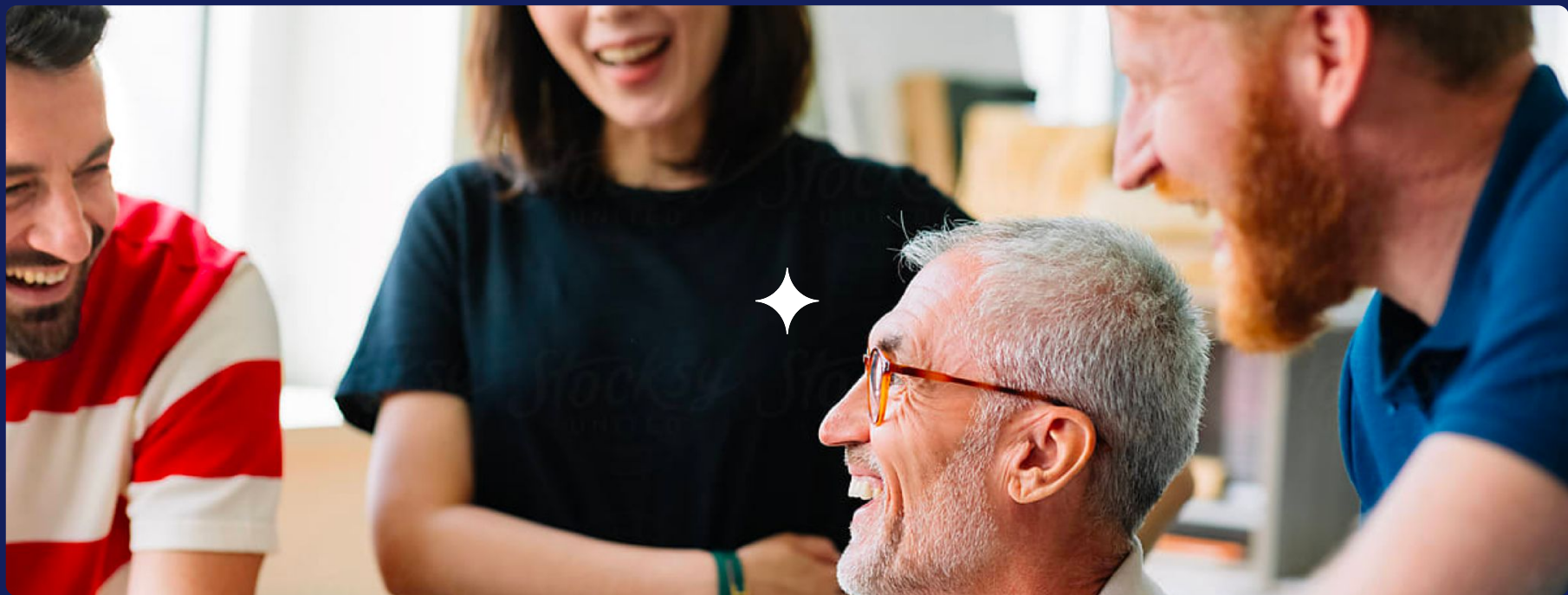
01 Enrollment Periods Review

02 What are Special Enrollment Periods? (SEP's)

03 Most Common SEP's and when to use

04 Compliant Use of SEP's

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Enrollment Periods



Enrollment Periods for MA, MAPD & PDP

IEP

Initial Enrollment Period

When a beneficiary first enrolls in Medicare Parts A & B, can sign up for a Plan to coordinate with Medicare start date.

2nd IEP

2nd Initial Enrollment Period

For beneficiaries who have Medicare due to disability under 65. When turning 65, they have another 7-month IEP.

GEP

General Enrollment Period

If beneficiary misses IEP, can sign up for Medicare between January 1 and March 31 each year. LEP will apply. Medicare coverage starts first of month after sign up. Can sign up for a Plan to start same day Medicare coverage starts.



Enrollment Periods for MA/MAPD/PDP

AEP

Annual Enrollment Period

October 15-December 7 each year. Can change their MAPD/PDP for coverage beginning January 1 following year.

MA OEP

MA Annual Open Enrollment Period

Jan 1-Mar 31st each year. Beneficiary on a MA/MAPD plan can make one Plan change during this time. Coverage begins first of month following enrollment.

MA OEP (NEW)

MA Open Enrollment Period(New)

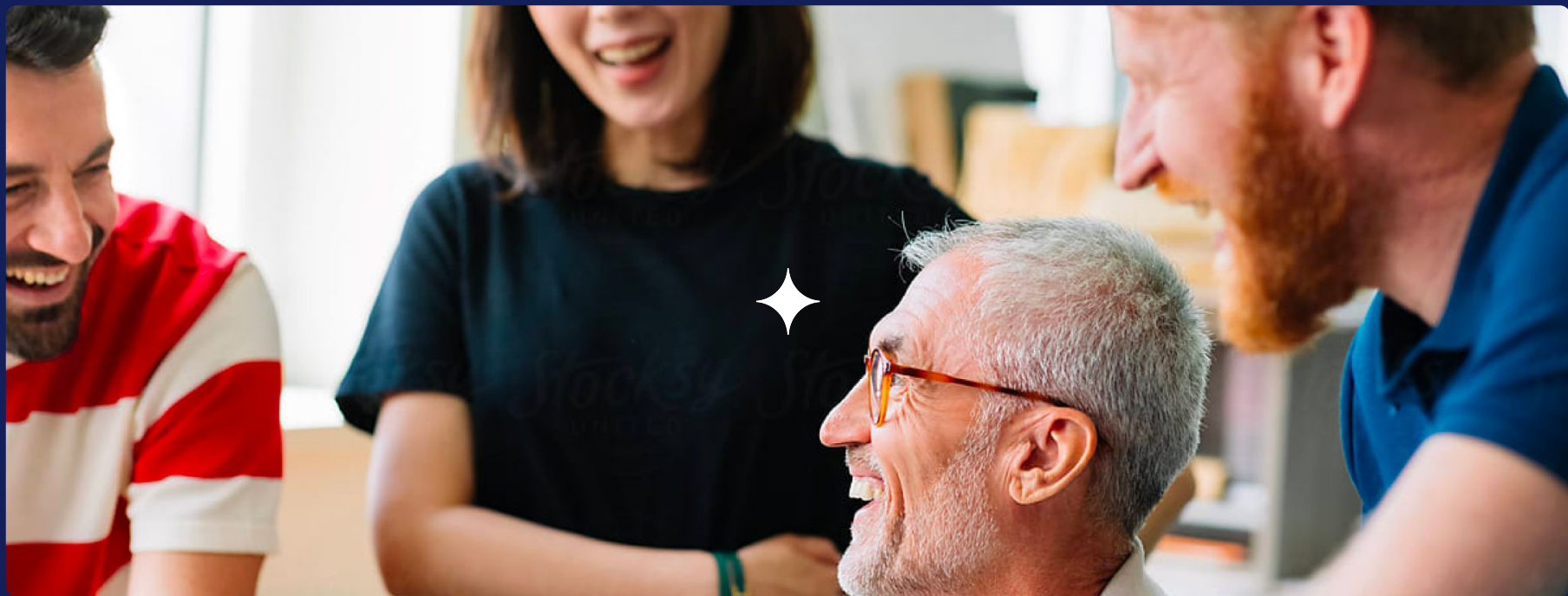
Available to new Medicare Advantage enrollees following IEP/ICEP with their Medicare entitlement. The one-time election begins the month of entitlement (effective date) to Part A and Part B and for two additional months.



Medicare Supplement OEP

Medicare Supplement Open Enrollment Period (OEP) is different from MA OEP

- 6 months after signing up for Part B and age 65
- Beneficiary has guaranteed issue for a Medicare Supplement Plan
- Beneficiary can apply for a Medicare Supplement anytime, but will go through Medical Underwriting if after 6 month Open Enrollment Period (Unless have guaranteed insurability(GI) rights)



Special Enrollment Periods (SEP's)



What are SEP's?

When a Medicare Beneficiary has a change in circumstances or a qualifying life event occurs, they may be able to take advantage of one of the SEP's CMS has granted

- With a SEP the beneficiary has the ability to change their Medicare Plan (MAPD/PDP)
- This SEP may or may not also coincide with an SEP to sign up for Medicare
- Each SEP comes with its own unique rules and timeframes



Loss of Employer Coverage

SEP to sign up for Medicare

- When they lose the group coverage (retirement, spouse retiring), they become eligible for an 8-month SEP to sign up for Medicare.
- This SEP begins when they stop working or when coverage through employer ends - whichever happens earlier.
- Beneficiary will have to sign up for Part B -online is easiest at ssa.gov

SEP to sign up for a Plan

- The eight-month SEP to sign up for Part B of Medicare is different from the time frame (SEP) beneficiaries have to enroll in a MAPD or PDP.
- Beneficiaries have a SEP to join a MAPD or PDP plan after leaving group coverage for 2 months after their group coverage ends.
- They will have a gap in coverage if the Plan start date doesn't coincide with the end date of their group coverage.

More Medicare beneficiaries are working past the age of 65, staying on their employer health plan, and delaying enrolling in Medicare. (usually enrolling in premium free A and delaying Part B enrollment) Note: Make sure group coverage is creditable before delaying Medicare enrollment (group plans from employers with more than 20 employees)



Change where you Live

Moving out of Plan Service Area

- If current plan is not available at new location, can switch to a new Plan
- Can switch to a new Plan if there are new Plan options at new location, even if current plan is also available
- 2-Month SEP
 - If member tells the Plan before moving, the SEP begins the month before the move and continues for 2 full months after move
 - If member tells the Plan after moving, the SEP begins the month they tell the Plan plus 2 full months

Other

- **Live in, or recently moved out of an institution**
 - Can join, switch, or drop coverage as long as they live in the institution and for 2 full months after they move out
- **Move back to the U.S. after living outside the country**
 - 2-month SEP to join a Plan after moving back to U.S.
- **Released from jail or incarceration**
 - 2-month SEP after released to join a Plan. (If they paid for Part B (and Part A if applicable) while in jail)
 - They must sign up for Medicare before joining a Plan if they don't have it



Gain, Lose, or have a Change to LIS/Extra Help

Individuals who Gain, Lose or Have a Change in their LIS-Eligible status have a SEP which includes those who:

- Become eligible for LIS (but who do not receive Medicaid benefits); or
- Lose eligibility for any type of assistance.
- The SEP allows the individual one opportunity to make an election within three months of any of the changes noted above, or notification of such a change, whichever is later. They can enroll in a MAPD or a PDP.
- The effective date for enrollments is the first day of the month following receipt of the enrollment request
- **This is a different SEP than the ongoing monthly SEP for LIS/EH beneficiaries



Monthly SEP for LIS/Extra Help

For all dual-eligible and LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries

- Individuals who have Medicare and receive any type of Federal or State assistance from Medicaid or Low Income Subsidy (LIS) a.k.a. Extra Help have a monthly SEP to **newly enroll into or change to a different PDP**.
- This coverage is effective the first of the upcoming month.
- An individual is not eligible for this SEP if the individual has been identified as an “at-risk beneficiary” or “potential at-risk beneficiary”.



Gain, Lose, or have a Change to Medicaid Status

Note: This is different than the ongoing monthly INT SEP for full benefit dual eligible beneficiaries

Individuals who Gain, Lose or Have a Change in their Medicaid status have a SEP which includes those who:

- Become eligible for any type of assistance from the Title XIX program (including “partial duals” who receive cost sharing assistance under Medicaid); or
- Lose eligibility for any type of assistance; or
- Have a change in the level of assistance they receive (e.g., stop receiving Medicaid benefits, but still qualify for LIS, those who have a change in cost sharing).
- The SEP allows the individual one opportunity to make an election within three months of any of the changes noted above, or notification of such a change, whichever is later. They can enroll in a PDP or MAPD.
- The effective date for enrollments under this SEP is the first day of the month following receipt of the enrollment request.



Monthly SEP for Dual Eligibles (SEP-INT)

For full-benefit dual-eligible beneficiaries (i.e., those who are FBDE, QMB+ or SLMB+)

- A monthly SEP for full-benefit dual-eligible beneficiaries to enroll into integrated and aligned D-SNPs to align enrollment between their Medicare and Medicaid plans
- The Integrated SEP can only be used to enroll into 1 of these 3 plan types:
 - 1. A Fully Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE SNP)
 - 2. A Highly Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (HIDE SNP)
 - 3. A D-SNP that is an Applicable Integrated Plan (AIP)
- Not all D-SNPs are considered Integrated. Check Carrier Portals for more information.
- Enrollment effective date is the first of the following month.



C-SNP SEP

C-SNP SEP is available year round to beneficiaries who qualify:

- Beneficiaries who have been diagnosed with one of the qualifying chronic conditions covered by the plan can use this SEP if they are not currently in a C-SNP Plan.
- If they are diagnosed with a new chronic condition that's not covered on their current C-SNP, they'll get a new SEP. They can enroll in another C-SNP that will help them manage that condition.
- They only get one SEP for each new condition that qualifies.
- After they join a C-SNP for their condition, the SEP ends.
- If member loses their C-SNP plan because they no longer meet the conditions, they have a 2 month SEP to join another plan.



Other common SEP's

DST

If CMS declares a “natural disaster” SEP-DST for hurricanes, floods, tornados, and other events. The time frame for the SEP is determined at the time it’s announced.

Beneficiary is eligible **if they had another election period they missed due to the natural disaster.**

Trial Right

If a beneficiary drops a Medicare Supplement policy and joins a MAPD plan for the first time, the beneficiary has a **12-month** “trial period”. The beneficiary can drop the MAPD policy and go back to Original Medicare with Special Rights to go back to a Medicare Supplement and PDP.



Other common SEP's

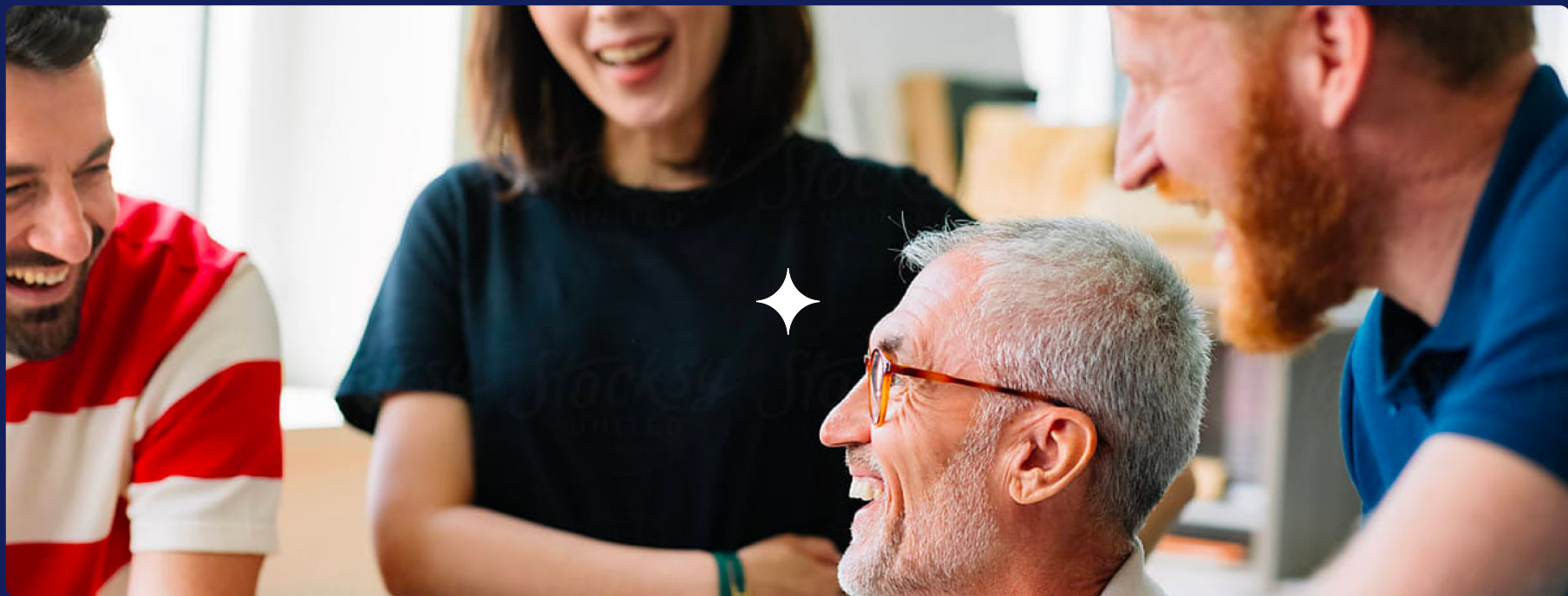
5-Star Plan

If a **5-star rating Plan** is available in the beneficiary's area, the beneficiary can use this SEP once between December 8th and November 30th the following year to switch from their current plan to a 5-star Plan.

SPAP

If a beneficiary is enrolled in a **State Pharmaceutical Assistance Program (SPAP)**, the beneficiary can join a MAPD or PDP plan. They can use this SEP once during the calendar year.

If a beneficiary loses SPAP eligibility, the beneficiary can join a MAPD or PDP plan. The SEP starts the month they lose eligibility or the month notified, whichever is earlier, and ends 2 months after month of loss or notification of loss, whichever is later.



SEP Compliance



SEP Eligibility

Make sure you ask enough questions to determine if the client is eligible for a SEP.

- Has the beneficiary recently moved? If so, when?
- Is the beneficiary leaving employer coverage? If so, when?
- Were they recently informed of eligibility into state's Medicaid program, a change in Medicaid status or loss of Medicaid? If so, when?
- Does the beneficiary currently have Medicaid? Which MCO in their state provides their Medicaid coverage?
- If a C-SNP is available, do they meet the chronic condition(s) for eligibility?

IMPORTANT! You must ask the questions, discuss, and verify the Election Period being used with the beneficiary prior to the enrollment. (Election Period Verification)



Misuse of SEP's

SEP's remain available throughout the year, but they are subject to heightened scrutiny from both CMS and carriers.

- SEPs must be tied to a legitimate and clearly defined qualifying event.
- Agents must not use SEPs as a workaround to continue enrolling members outside of SEP allowances
- Eligibility must be verified prior to enrollment, not assumed or inferred.
- The qualifying event must be clearly explained to the beneficiary in a way that demonstrates understanding.
- Documentation must support the SEP in the event of carrier audit or CMS inquiry.

✦ SEP Watchlist

DST

Weather/Disaster SEP

Carrier Thresholds:
<15% of enrollments*

Qualification:

Should never be advertised or marketed. Must be eligible for another election period and have missed it due to the disaster. (i.e. did not make an election in their IEP, AEP, etc.)

MOV

Moving SEP

Carrier Thresholds:
<10% of enrollments*

Qualification:

Must have had an address change with Medicare/Social Security in the last 2 months.

LCC

Loss of Creditable Coverage SEP

Carrier Thresholds:
<4% of enrollments

Qualification:

Must have lost other creditable coverage. (i.e. Plan did not renew/Medicare terminates plan's contract, involuntary loss of creditable coverage).

ACC

Accessible Format SEP

Carrier Thresholds:
<3% of enrollments

Qualification:

Only use if a beneficiary truly needs/wants accessible format materials. Do not use otherwise.

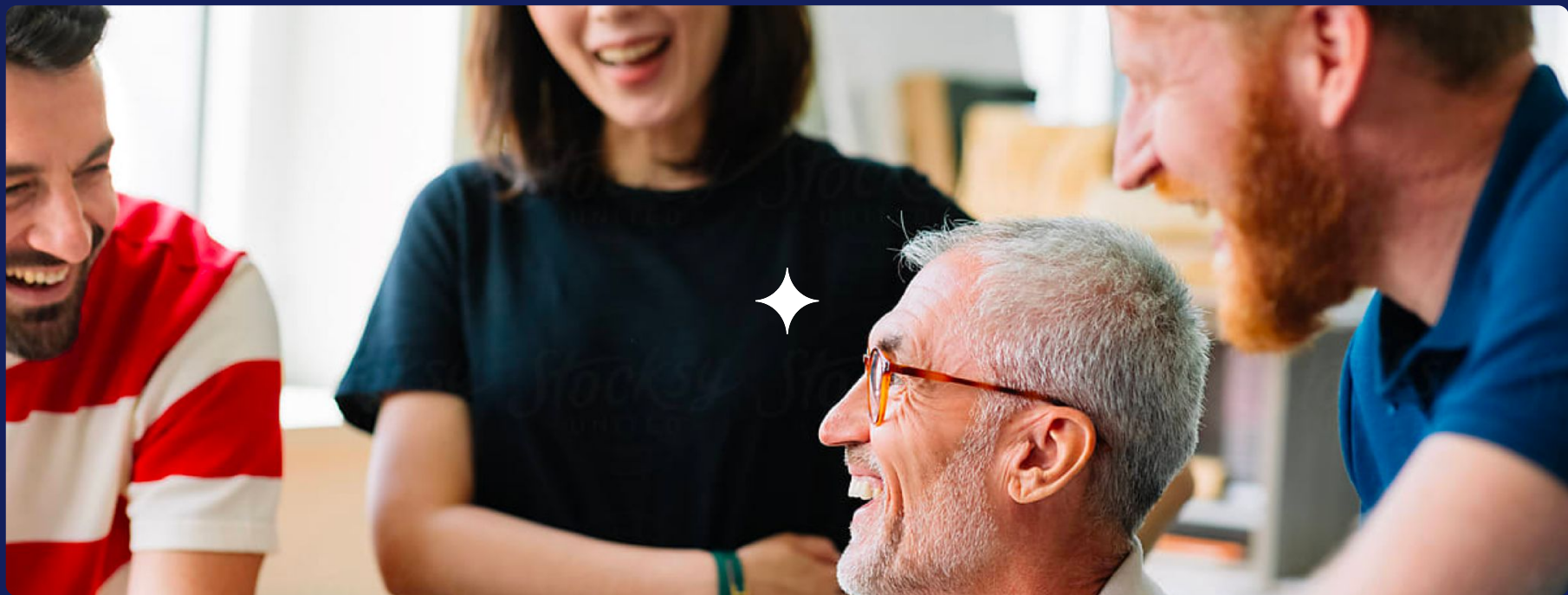
PAP

State Pharmaceutical Assistance Program SEP

Carrier Thresholds:
<5% of enrollments

Qualification:

Must be enrolled in a State Pharmaceutical Assistance Program (SPAP) or have lost SPAP eligibility.

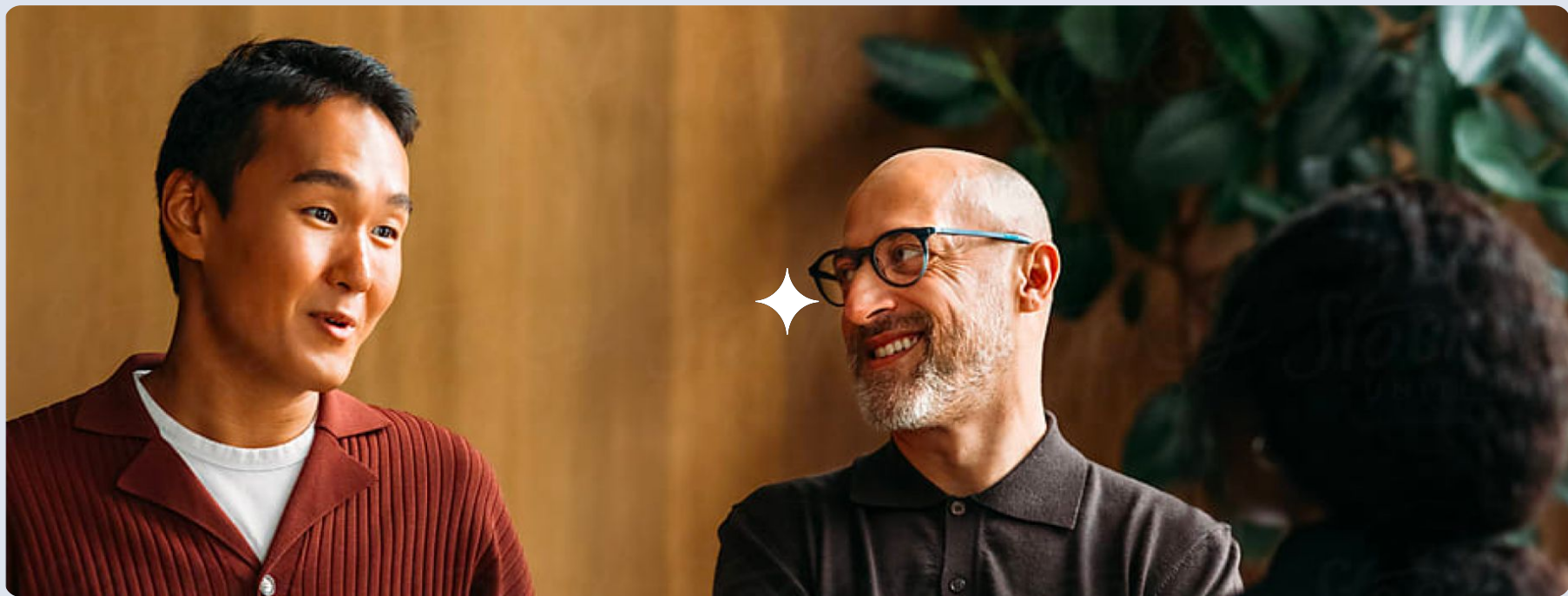


Resources



Resources

- Medicare.gov - search Special Enrollment Periods
- Spark Help Center - both the Training Page and the Compliance page have resources/webinars, etc.
- Carrier Broker Portals - many have Election Period Job Aids on their site
- Sunfire - has a feature for assistance with D-SNP HIDE/FIDE/AIP Plans.
- Upline Support - reach out to your immediate upline for assistance
- Spark Support - reach out to Compliance@SparkAdvisors.com with any questions.



Q & A

Thank You

CONTACT

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